ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

Clubs, Leadership and Volunteering: Build Skills Without Losing Your Semester

Choose activities that develop you and still leave room for your degree

CAMPUS LIFE

Campus Life

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

Extracurricular activity can build real skills or quietly consume your study time. This pack helps you choose a small number of commitments deliberately, contribute well, and record what you learn in a way that later helps with internships and job applications.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Choose activities aligned with your goals and available time.
- Contribute effectively in a team and handle responsibility reliably.
- Balance leadership roles with academic workload.
- Record achievements and skills for future applications.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

Choose deliberately

Depth in two activities beats shallow membership in eight.

- Decide what you want to develop: communication, organisation, technical skill or a network.
- Attend a meeting before committing to a role.
- Ask current members how much time the role actually takes.
- Check that meetings do not clash with core lectures or labs.
- Prefer organisations with clear structures and real projects.
- Leave gracefully if an activity is consuming your study time.

Work well in a team

Reliability is the most valued trait in student teams.

- Confirm what you own and when it is due.
- Communicate early when a deadline is at risk.
- Write brief minutes with decisions and owners.
- Do the unglamorous tasks sometimes; it builds trust.
- Give credit publicly and correct privately.
- Document events with photos and simple reports for continuity.

> **Leadership is not a title**
> A treasurer who keeps clean records and a volunteer who shows up consistently are doing more leadership than a titleholder who disappears.

Record what you learn

Experience that cannot be described is hard to use later.

- Keep a simple log: role, dates, tasks, results and skills used.
- Quantify where possible: number of participants, funds raised, sessions organised.
- Collect one or two references from supervisors.
- Save certificates and photographs in a folder.
- Reflect on one failure each semester and what you changed.
- Turn the log into CV bullet points while details are fresh.